

Vipin Sahu, CEO of Webkul and founder of the e-commerce platform Bagisto, talks about the latter's growth story in an exclusive interaction with Sreejani Bhattacharya of *OSFY*. Bagisto was founded by Vipin Sahu along with Jitendra Singh, Nitish Kumar and Saurav Pathak. He also discusses at length the problems the open source community faces in India.

Here are some interesting excerpts from the interview.

Vipin Sahu,
CEO of Webkul and founder of the
e-commerce platform Bagisto



“There is no investor for open source projects in India”

OSFY: What does Bagisto do and what is the target audience it caters to?

VS: Bagisto is an open source e-commerce platform built on Laravel. However, it is not limited just to e-commerce and also offers post-commerce solutions. The user can build marketplaces, point-of-sale (PoS) solutions, progressive Web apps (PWA), and dropship solutions using Bagisto.

The platform is highly scalable, flexible and can be customised by developers working on the Laravel framework. Any small, medium or enterprise merchant can easily use Bagisto to build its e-commerce platform. Developers and freelancers can use Bagisto to build their own customised e-commerce solution and deliver it to their client in a short span of time.

OSFY: How did the idea to launch an open source e-commerce platform come about?

VS: Open source e-commerce already has many big players like Magento, WooCommerce, OpenCart, and so on. Webkul has been working since the past 10 years on almost all major e-commerce platforms, and we found that there is a huge gap between demand and supply when it comes to platform-driven e-commerce solutions. If someone has worked on a model view controller (MVC) architecture framework like Symfony or Laravel, they will know it is very hard to develop an e-commerce solution for these. They either need to write code from scratch, or learn a new platform completely and adapt to that. If somebody needs to work on Magento, they need to learn Magento first.

The very idea that anyone working on any MVC framework architecture can develop their e-commerce system led us to work on Bagisto. So, if someone has worked on a popular MVC architecture platform such as Laravel,

they can easily use Bagisto and develop a custom solution.

Also, most frameworks today do not make use of recent technologies. But the world is moving towards headless architecture and progressive Web apps (PWAs). In a country like India, there are still places where the Internet does not function properly. PWAs can have a big impact as they offer offline functionality to both small and medium merchants. We believe these technologies should be at the core of e-commerce.

OSFY: What is the business model of the company? How does it generate revenue?

VS: We work on a wide range of platforms — 22 platforms to be exact, which includes Salesforce, Odoo, WooCommerce, Magento, etc. We work on developing tools and plugins for e-commerce frameworks, and customising ERP and CMS solutions. The sale of these plugins